



FREE TEMPLATE • INDIE MUSIC INDIA

# Music Business Plan Template, India

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Instructions: Complete one plan per artist at the start of the management relationship. Review and update every 6 months. This is a working document, not a pitch deck.

**Artist:** \_\_\_\_\_

**Manager:** \_\_\_\_\_

**Plan Date:** \_\_\_\_\_

**Review Date:** \_\_\_\_\_

## Section 1: The Artist

1.1 Who are they? [Write 2-3 sentences describing the artist as a musical entity. What is the sound? What is the emotional territory? Who does it remind people of, and how is it different?]

1.2 What stage are they at?

- Pre-release (no public music yet)
- Early (1-3 releases, under 5,000 monthly listeners)
- Growing (4+ releases, 5,000-50,000 monthly listeners)
- Established (50,000+ monthly listeners, regular live income)

1.3 What is genuinely good about this artist? [Not marketing language. What is the real reason someone would seek this artist out over everything else available?]

1.4 What is the honest challenge? [What is currently holding this artist back? Be specific.]

## Section 2: The Market

2.1 Indian Indie Landscape India has approximately 400-500 actively releasing independent artists across genres. The domestic streaming market is enormous but per-stream rates are low (approximately USD 0.001-0.003 per stream on major platforms from Indian listeners vs. USD 0.003-0.005 from US/UK listeners). The live market in Tier 1 cities (Mumbai, Bengaluru, Delhi, Pune, Hyderabad) is the most reliable revenue source for independent artists earning below 1M monthly listeners.

2.2 Target Audience Primary audience: [Describe the most likely fan. Age range, cities, what else they listen to, how they discover music] Secondary audience: [Who else might find this

artist?]

2.3 Comparable Artists (Comps) List 3-5 artists whose career trajectory you are using as a reference point:

[e.g. Prateek Kuhad: Monthly Listeners: 2.5M Live fee range: INR 3-8L per show

Label/Independent: Independent What it tells us: Shows what's possible without a label deal]

Artist 1: Monthly Listeners: \_\_\_ Live fee range: \_\_\_ Label/Independent: \_\_\_ What the comparison tells us: \_\_\_ Artist 2: Monthly Listeners: \_\_\_ Live fee range: \_\_\_ Label/Independent: \_\_\_ What the comparison tells us: \_\_\_ Artist 3: Monthly Listeners: \_\_\_ Live fee range: \_\_\_ Label/Independent: \_\_\_ What the comparison tells us: \_\_\_

2.4 Opportunity [What is the specific opening in the market this artist can occupy? Is there a genre, language, city, or audience that is underserved?]

## Section 3: Goals

3.1 12-Month Goals (be specific and measurable)

Monthly Listeners (Spotify): Current \_\_\_ / Target \_\_\_ YouTube Subscribers: Current \_\_\_ / Target \_\_\_ Instagram Followers: Current \_\_\_ / Target \_\_\_ Number of releases: \_\_\_ Number of headline shows: \_\_\_ Number of festival appearances: \_\_\_ Target monthly music income (INR): \_\_\_ Primary milestone this year: \_\_\_\_\_

3.2 3-Year Vision [What does success look like in 3 years? Describe it concretely, what the artist is releasing, where they are performing, what their income is, who knows their name.]

## Section 4: Revenue Model

4.1 Current Revenue Streams Streaming royalties Monthly Average (INR): \_\_\_ Notes: \_\_\_ Live performances Monthly Average (INR): \_\_\_ Notes: \_\_\_ Brand partnerships Monthly Average (INR): \_\_\_ Notes: \_\_\_ Sync licensing Monthly Average (INR): \_\_\_ Notes: \_\_\_ Merchandise Monthly Average (INR): \_\_\_ Notes: \_\_\_ Teaching / workshops Monthly Average (INR): \_\_\_ Notes: \_\_\_ Other Monthly Average (INR): \_\_\_ Notes: \_\_\_ TOTAL Monthly Average (INR): \_\_\_

4.2 12-Month Revenue Projections Streaming royalties Monthly Target (INR): \_\_\_ Annual Target (INR): \_\_\_ How we get there: \_\_\_ Live performances Monthly Target (INR): \_\_\_ Annual Target (INR): \_\_\_ How we get there: \_\_\_ Brand partnerships Monthly Target (INR): \_\_\_ Annual Target (INR): \_\_\_ How we get there: \_\_\_ Sync licensing Monthly Target (INR): \_\_\_ Annual Target (INR): \_\_\_ How we get there: \_\_\_ Merchandise Monthly Target (INR): \_\_\_ Annual Target (INR): \_\_\_ How we get there: \_\_\_ TOTAL Monthly Target (INR): \_\_\_ Annual Target (INR): \_\_\_

4.3 Priority Revenue Focus Given the artist's current stage, which 1-2 revenue streams should be the primary focus in the next 12 months, and why? [e.g. "Live performances in Bengaluru and Pune, because the artist already has a following in these cities and has the stage presence to convert shows into word-of-mouth growth."]

## Section 5: Release Strategy

5.1 Planned Releases (next 12 months) Release 1: Type: \_\_\_ Target Date: \_\_\_ Distributor: \_\_\_ Budget (INR): \_\_\_ Lead time needed: \_\_\_ Release 2: Type: \_\_\_ Target Date: \_\_\_ Distributor: \_\_\_ Budget (INR): \_\_\_ Lead time needed: \_\_\_

5.2 Distribution Current distributor: \_\_\_\_\_ Contract term ends: \_\_\_\_\_ Commission / fee structure: \_\_\_\_\_ Is this the right distributor? [ ] Yes [ ] No, reason: \_\_\_\_\_

5.3 Release Budget (per single) Recording / production Estimated Cost (INR): \_\_\_ Mixing Estimated Cost (INR): \_\_\_ Mastering Estimated Cost (INR): \_\_\_ Music video Estimated Cost (INR): \_\_\_ Photography Estimated Cost (INR): \_\_\_ PR campaign Estimated Cost (INR): \_\_\_ Paid promotion (Meta/YouTube) Estimated Cost (INR): \_\_\_ Distribution fee Estimated Cost (INR): \_\_\_ TOTAL Estimated Cost (INR): \_\_\_

## Section 6: Live Strategy

6.1 Current Live Status Has the artist performed live before? [ ] Yes [ ] No Current headline fee range: INR \_\_\_ to \_\_\_ Current support act fee range: INR \_\_\_ to \_\_\_ Does the artist have a full band? [ ] Yes [ ] No, current setup: \_\_\_\_\_

6.2 Target Markets (next 12 months) City 1: Strategy: \_\_\_ Key venues / promoters: \_\_\_ Target # shows: \_\_\_ Target fee: \_\_\_ City 2: Strategy: \_\_\_ Key venues / promoters: \_\_\_ Target # shows: \_\_\_ Target fee: \_\_\_ City 3: Strategy: \_\_\_ Key venues / promoters: \_\_\_ Target # shows: \_\_\_ Target fee: \_\_\_

6.3 Festival Targets NH7 Weekender Application deadline: \_\_\_ Contact: \_\_\_ Status: \_\_\_ Magnetic Fields Application deadline: \_\_\_ Contact: \_\_\_ Status: \_\_\_ Ziro Festival Application deadline: \_\_\_ Contact: \_\_\_ Status: \_\_\_ Boxout Weekender Application deadline: \_\_\_ Contact: \_\_\_ Status: \_\_\_ [Add others] Application deadline: \_\_\_ Contact: \_\_\_ Status: \_\_\_

## Section 7: Marketing And Communications

7.1 Brand Identity Visual aesthetic: \_\_\_\_\_ Tone of voice online: \_\_\_\_\_ What the artist will NOT do (boundaries): \_\_\_\_\_

7.2 Social Media Strategy Instagram Current followers: \_\_\_ Posting frequency: \_\_\_ Content focus: \_\_\_ Owner: \_\_\_ YouTube Current followers: \_\_\_ Posting frequency: \_\_\_ Content focus: \_\_\_ Owner: \_\_\_ Twitter/X Current followers: \_\_\_ Posting frequency: \_\_\_ Content focus: \_\_\_ Owner: \_\_\_ Facebook Current followers: \_\_\_ Posting frequency: \_\_\_ Content focus: \_\_\_ Owner: \_\_\_

7.3 PR Strategy Target publications: \_\_\_\_\_ PR agency engaged? [ ] Yes, name: \_\_\_ [ ] No, DIY approach: \_\_\_\_\_ Key story angles this year: \_\_\_\_\_

## Section 8: Budget

8.1 Annual Operating Budget Recording and production Annual Budget (INR): \_\_\_\_ Marketing and promotion Annual Budget (INR): \_\_\_\_ PR Annual Budget (INR): \_\_\_\_ Live production (tech rider, travel, accommodation) Annual Budget (INR): \_\_\_\_ Management office costs Annual Budget (INR): \_\_\_\_ Legal fees Annual Budget (INR): \_\_\_\_ Accounting fees Annual Budget (INR): \_\_\_\_ Miscellaneous Annual Budget (INR): \_\_\_\_ TOTAL Annual Budget (INR): \_\_\_\_

## 8.2 Funding Source

- Artist self-funded
- Label advance
- Brand partnership advance
- Grant (specify): \_\_\_\_\_
- Manager co-investment
- Other: \_\_\_\_\_

## Section 9: Risks And Contingencies

Artist stops releasing Likelihood (H/M/L): \_\_\_\_ Impact (H/M/L): \_\_\_\_ Mitigation: \_\_\_\_ Key show cancelled Likelihood (H/M/L): \_\_\_\_ Impact (H/M/L): \_\_\_\_ Mitigation: \_\_\_\_ Label deal collapses Likelihood (H/M/L): \_\_\_\_ Impact (H/M/L): \_\_\_\_ Mitigation: \_\_\_\_ Artist signs with another manager Likelihood (H/M/L): \_\_\_\_ Impact (H/M/L): \_\_\_\_ Mitigation: \_\_\_\_ Platform algorithm change hurts streams Likelihood (H/M/L): \_\_\_\_ Impact (H/M/L): \_\_\_\_ Mitigation: \_\_\_\_

## Section 10: Review Log

1. Date: \_\_\_\_ Reviewed by: \_\_\_\_ Key changes made: \_\_\_\_ Next review date: \_\_\_\_

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